Sulabham · Day 1

HISTORY · Indus Valley Civilization

UNDERSTAND IT FIRST

What is it? About 4,500 years ago, people in the plains of the Indus river and its neighbouring rivers began to live in planned towns with brick houses, drains, weights and measures, and long-distance trade. This is India's first urban (city) civilization. 'Urban' means people are not only farmers: some are traders, craftsmen, officials. That needs surplus food, so farming must be productive first. **Why does it matter for the exam?** It is the starting point of Indian history and APPSC asks about its sites, town planning, trade and decline every year.

1. How was it discovered?

In 1921 **Daya Ram Sahni** found Harappa (now in Pakistan). In 1922 **R.D. Banerji** found Mohenjo-daro. **John Marshall**, Director-General of the Archaeological Survey of India, announced the discovery to the world in 1924. That is why it is also called the **Harappan Civilization**: archaeologists name a culture after the first site found.

2. Where and when?

The mature phase is dated roughly **2600 BCE to 1900 BCE** (a Bronze Age civilization: copper and bronze were used, iron was not known). It spread over the Indus and Ghaggar–Hakra river plains: today's Pakistan, north-west India (Punjab, Haryana, Rajasthan, Gujarat) and part of Afghanistan. It was larger than Egypt and Mesopotamia combined, but its script is still **undeciphered**, so we know it mostly from digging, not from reading.

3. The big idea: a planned town

Imagine a town built by a plan, not by chance. Streets met at right angles (a grid). Houses used standard-size burnt bricks. Every house had a bathroom, and waste water ran into **covered drains** along the street. The town had two parts: a raised **citadel** (west) for rulers and public buildings, and a **lower town** (east) where most people lived. Such care shows a strong civic authority. Compare: most medieval Indian towns grew without any such planning.

Site	Where	Why it is famous
Harappa	Punjab (Pakistan), River Ravi	First site found; granary; workers' quarters
Mohenjo-daro	Sindh (Pakistan), Indus	**Great Bath**; best drainage; 'mound of the dead'
Lothal	Gujarat, near Bhogavo	**Dockyard** (port); bead-making; trade with Mesopotamia
Dholavira	Gujarat (Kutch)	**Water-conservation system**; three-part city; UNESCO World Heritage Site (2021)
Kalibangan	Rajasthan, Ghaggar	**Ploughed field**; fire altars
Rakhigarhi	Haryana	Largest Harappan site in India
Chanhudaro	Sindh (Pakistan)	Bead and bangle workshops; no citadel

4. How did people live?

- **Farming:** wheat and barley; cotton was grown (cotton cloth appears early here, a world first). Rivers flooded and left fertile silt; fields did not need big canals.
- **Crafts and trade:** bead-making, pottery, copper and bronze tools. They traded with **Mesopotamia** (called **Meluhha** in Mesopotamian texts). Standard **cubical stone weights** and **seals** (square steatite stamps with animals and script) controlled trade.
- **Religion:** no certain temples. Seals show a horned figure sitting in yoga posture (called **Pashupati**), mother-goddess figurines, and tree and animal worship.
- **Society:** no royal palaces or big tombs found, so historians debate who ruled. Houses differ in size, so some social difference existed.

5. Why did it decline? (a causes list, not one answer)

There is no single agreed cause. Scholars point to: **change of climate and drying of the Ghaggar–Hakra river**, floods and river shifting, falling trade with Mesopotamia, and breakdown of city control. The old 'Aryan invasion' idea is not supported by evidence of mass killing and is now largely rejected. After about 1900 BCE people moved east and south into smaller villages: the cities faded, the culture did not vanish overnight.

> **EXAM TRAP**
>
> Great Bath is at **Mohenjo-daro**, the granary at **Harappa**, the dockyard at **Lothal**, the water system at **Dholavira**, the ploughed field at **Kalibangan**. Harappans did not use iron, did not know the horse widely, and their script is undeciphered. Do not write 'Mohenjo-daro in India': it is in Pakistan.

Test yourself: 5 questions (answer given below each)

PRACTICE

Consider the following statements about the Indus Valley Civilization:

1. Dholavira is known for its water-conservation system.

2. Lothal had a dockyard.

3. Kalibangan has evidence of a ploughed field.

4. Iron was widely used by the Harappans.

Which of the above are correct?

A. 1, 2 and 3 only

B. 1, 2 and 4 only

C. 2, 3 and 4 only

D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: A. It was a Bronze Age civilization; iron was not used, so 4 is wrong.

PRACTICE

Match List-I (feature) with List-II (site):

List-I: A. Great Bath B. Dockyard C. Ploughed field D. Largest site in India

List-II: 1. Lothal 2. Rakhigarhi 3. Mohenjo-daro 4. Kalibangan

A. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

B. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2

C. A-1, B-3, C-4, D-2

D. A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

Answer: A. Great Bath: Mohenjo-daro; dockyard: Lothal; ploughed field: Kalibangan; largest in India: Rakhigarhi.

PRACTICE

Which one of the following statements about the Indus Valley Civilization is NOT correct?

A. Its mature phase is dated roughly 2600–1900 BCE.

B. It traded with Mesopotamia, known as Meluhha.

C. Its script has been fully deciphered.

D. Standard cubical stone weights were used.

Answer: C. The script remains undeciphered; this is why we depend on excavation.

PRACTICE

Assertion (A): Harappan towns are described as 'planned towns'.
Reason (R): Streets met at right angles, houses used standard burnt bricks and covered drains ran along the streets.
Choose the correct answer:

A. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A

B. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

C. A is true but R is false

D. A is false but R is true

Answer: A. The grid streets, uniform bricks and drains are exactly what 'planned' means.

PRACTICE

Which of the following are supported by most scholars as causes of the decline of Harappan cities?
1. Drying of the Ghaggar–Hakra river and climate change
2. A mass-killing invasion proved by skeletons in all cities
3. Fall in trade with Mesopotamia
4. River shifting and floods
Select the correct answer:

A. 1, 3 and 4 only

B. 1 and 2 only

C. 2, 3 and 4 only

D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: A. No evidence of a city-wide massacre exists; the 'invasion' theory is now largely rejected.

RECALL BOX: CLOSE THE NOTES AND WRITE THESE IN YOUR OWN WORDS

1. Why is a 'planned town' proof of a strong authority? 2. Give three site names with one speciality each. 3. List four possible causes of decline in your own words.

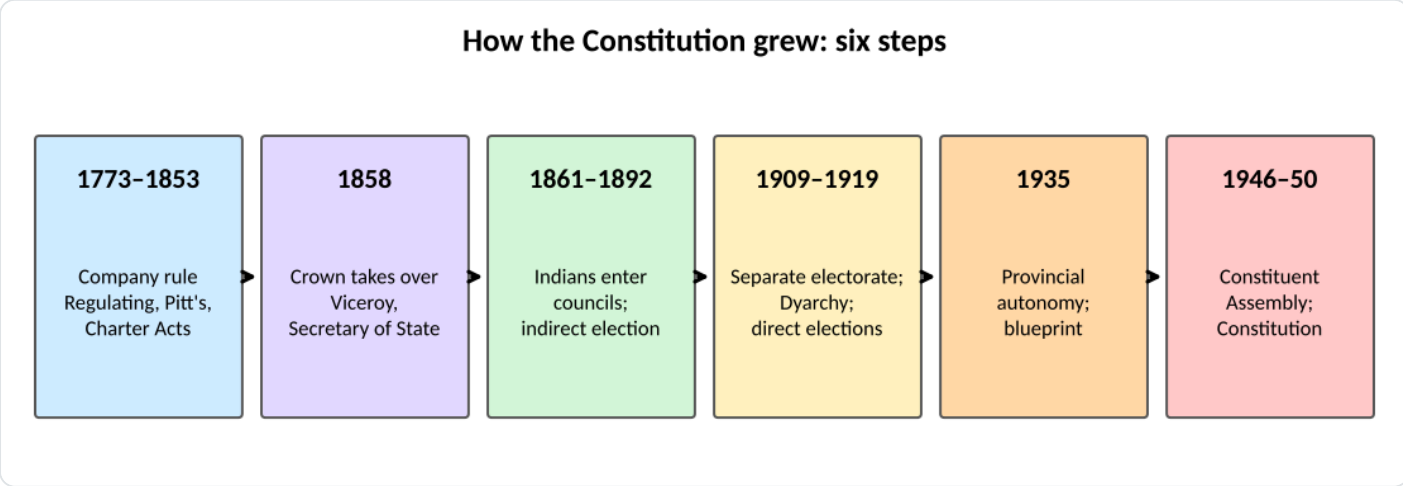
POLITY · Nature of the Indian Constitution and constitutional development

UNDERSTAND IT FIRST

What is a Constitution? It is the supreme rule book of a country. It does three jobs: it creates the organs of government (the legislature that makes laws, the executive that runs them, the judiciary that decides disputes); it **limits** their power so nobody becomes all-powerful; and it gives citizens **rights**. Every ordinary law must agree with it. Think of a cricket match: players change every season, but the rules stay, and the umpire can reject any play that breaks them. **Why it matters:** the Group 2 syllabus begins with this topic, and the rest of Polity (rights, Parliament, courts) all builds on it.

1. How it developed: the story in five steps

Our Constitution did not fall from the sky. Many of its ideas were tried first under British rule. Learn the story, then the years: **Company runs India → Crown takes over → Indians enter the councils → elections begin → provinces get self-rule → independence.**



The six steps of constitutional development

Step	Act (year)	What changed, and why it matters
1. Company rule	Regulating Act 1773	First step to control the Company: Governor of Bengal became Governor-General (Warren Hastings); Supreme Court at Calcutta (1774)
	Pitt's India Act 1784	Board of Control: 'double government' of Company and Crown
	Charter Act 1833	Governor-General of **India** (William Bentinck): full centralisation
	Charter Act 1853	Open competition for civil services; legislative work separated from executive
2. Crown rule	Government of India Act 1858	After the 1857 Revolt the Crown took over; Secretary of State for India; Viceroy (Canning)
3. Indians enter councils	Indian Councils Act 1861	Indians nominated to the council; portfolio system; ordinance power
4. Elections begin	Indian Councils Act 1892	Indirect election begins; members may discuss the budget
	Morley–Minto 1909	**Separate electorate** for Muslims (seeds of communal politics); S.P. Sinha first Indian in Viceroy's Executive Council
	Montagu–Chelmsford 1919	**Dyarchy** in provinces; two-house central legislature; direct elections
5. Self-rule	Government of India Act 1935	Provincial autonomy; proposed federation; three lists; Federal Court (1937). **Biggest source of our Constitution.**
6. Independence	Cabinet Mission 1946; Indian Independence Act 1947	Constituent Assembly formed; India independent on 15 Aug 1947; Assembly becomes sovereign

Memory chain: R-P-C-C (1773, 1784, 1833, 1853) = Company years; 1858 = Crown; 61, 92, 1909, 1919 = Indians, elections, separate electorates, dyarchy; 1935 = the blueprint.

2. How the Constitution was made: the Constituent Assembly

A Constituent Assembly is a body elected to write a constitution. Ours was formed under the Cabinet Mission Plan (1946): members were elected **indirectly** by the provincial assemblies (princely states sent nominees). It had 389 planned seats (296 British India + 93 princely states); after Partition about 299 remained.

Event	Fact
First meeting	9 Dec 1946; temporary President **Dr Sachchidananda Sinha**
Permanent President	**Dr Rajendra Prasad** (11 Dec 1946); Constitutional Adviser **B.N. Rau**
Objectives Resolution	Moved by **Nehru** on 13 Dec 1946; adopted 22 Jan 1947; became the **Preamble**
Drafting Committee	Set up 29 Aug 1947; Chairman **Dr B.R. Ambedkar**; 7 members; Draft introduced 4 Nov 1948
Adopted / in force	Adopted **26 Nov 1949** (Constitution Day); in force **26 Jan 1950** (Republic Day)
Time / original size	2 years 11 months 18 days; 395 Articles, 22 Parts, 8 Schedules (now about 450 Articles, 25 Parts, 12 Schedules)

3. What kind of Constitution is it? (its nature)

- **Written and the longest in the world**, because it covers the Centre, States, services, elections and emergency in one document.
- **Federal with a unitary bias** (K.C. Wheare: 'quasi-federal'). Two levels of government and a division of powers (Seventh Schedule), but a strong Centre: single Constitution, single citizenship, Governor appointed by the Centre, emergency powers. Article 1 calls India a '**Union of States**'.
- **Parliamentary system** (British model): real power with the Council of Ministers responsible to the Lok Sabha.
- **Flexible and rigid together:** some parts change by a simple majority, others need a special majority, and a few also need half the States.

EXAMPLE

Example: Why a 'federal with unitary bias' label? If a State Government fails, the Centre can impose President's Rule (Art 356). A pure federation like the USA has no such power. That one rule shows the 'unitary bias'.

EXAM TRAP

Adopted on 26 Nov 1949 but enforced on 26 Jan 1950 (the day was chosen because Purna Swaraj was declared on 26 Jan 1930). The temporary President was Sachchidananda Sinha, not Rajendra Prasad. 'Union of States', not 'Federation', is the wording of Article 1.

Test yourself: 5 questions (answer given below each)

PRACTICE

Consider the following statements:

1. The Regulating Act 1773 created a Supreme Court at Calcutta.

2. The Charter Act 1833 made the Governor-General of Bengal the Governor-General of India.

3. The Indian Councils Act 1892 introduced direct elections.

4. The Government of India Act 1858 ended Company rule.

Which of the above are correct?

A. 1, 2 and 4 only

B. 1, 2, 3 and 4

C. 2, 3 and 4 only

D. 1 and 3 only

Answer: A. The 1892 Act began indirect election, not direct. Direct elections came with the 1919 Act.

PRACTICE

Match List-I (Act) with List-II (feature):

List-I: A. Morley–Minto 1909 B. Montagu–Chelmsford 1919 C. Government of India Act 1935 D. Government of India Act 1858

List-II: 1. Federal Court 2. Separate electorates 3. Dyarchy in provinces 4. Secretary of State for India

A. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4

B. A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4

C. A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1

D. A-1, B-3, C-2, D-4

Answer: A. 1909: separate electorates; 1919: dyarchy; 1935: Federal Court (1937); 1858: Secretary of State.

PRACTICE

Consider the following statements about the Constituent Assembly:
1. Its members were elected indirectly by the provincial assemblies.
2. Its first meeting on 9 December 1946 was presided over by Sachchidananda Sinha.
3. The Objectives Resolution was moved by Dr B.R. Ambedkar.
4. The Drafting Committee was set up on 29 August 1947.
Which of the above are correct?

A. 1, 2 and 4 only

B. 1, 3 and 4 only

C. 2, 3 and 4 only

D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: A. The Objectives Resolution was moved by Jawaharlal Nehru (13 Dec 1946).

PRACTICE

Assertion (A): The Constitution of India came into force on 26 November 1949.
Reason (R): 26 January was chosen because Purna Swaraj was declared on 26 January 1930.
Choose the correct answer:

A. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A

B. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

C. A is true but R is false

D. A is false but R is true

Answer: D. It was adopted on 26 Nov 1949 and came into force on 26 Jan 1950. So A is false; R is true.

PRACTICE

A State Government is dismissed by the Centre and President's Rule is imposed in the State under Article 356. Which feature of the Indian Constitution does this best illustrate?

A. Federal structure with a unitary bias

B. Strict separation of powers

C. Independence of the judiciary

D. Universal adult franchise

Answer: A. The Centre's power to take over a State's administration shows the 'unitary bias' of our federal system.

RECALL BOX: CLOSE THE NOTES AND WRITE THESE IN YOUR OWN WORDS

1. Explain in four lines why the 1935 Act is called the blueprint of our Constitution. 2. Write the five-step story of constitutional development with one year for each step. 3. Why is the Constitution called 'federal with a unitary bias'? Give one example.

REASONING · Number series

UNDERSTAND IT FIRST

What is it? A number series is a list that follows a hidden rule. Your job is to find the rule and give the next number. The exam gives about 1–2 such questions and each takes under 40 seconds once you know the five common rules. **Method:** (1) look at the gaps between numbers; (2) if gaps are not equal, look at the gaps of the gaps; (3) test multiplication; (4) test squares/cubes; (5) test two interleaved series.

Rule	Example	Answer and why
Add a constant	2, 5, 8, 11, 14, ?	17: each term +3
Multiply by a constant	3, 6, 12, 24, 48, ?	96: each term ×2
Squares / cubes	1, 4, 9, 16, 25, ? and 1, 8, 27, 64, 125, ?	36 (6^2) and 216 (6^3)
Gaps grow	2, 6, 12, 20, 30, ?	42: gaps 4, 6, 8, 10, so next gap 12
Multiply then add	3, 7, 15, 31, 63, ?	127: each term ×2 + 1
Two series mixed	5, 10, 8, 16, 14, 28, ?	26: alternately ×2 and −2
Prime numbers	2, 3, 5, 7, 11, 13, ?	17: next prime

EXAMPLE

Worked example: 7, 10, 16, 28, 52, ? Gaps: 3, 6, 12, 24. The gaps double. Next gap = 48, so the answer is 52 + 48 = **100**.

Test yourself: 5 questions (answer given below each)

PRACTICE

Find the next number: 3, 8, 18, 38, 78, ?

A. 148

B. 156

C. 158

D. 160

Answer: C. Each term = previous × 2 + 2. 78 × 2 + 2 = 158. (The gaps are 5, 10, 20, 40, next gap 80.)

PRACTICE

Find the next number: 2, 12, 36, 80, 150, ?

A. 224

B. 252

C. 262

D. 240

Answer: B. Terms are $n^3 + n^2$: 1+1=2, 8+4=12, 27+9=36, 64+16=80, 125+25=150, so 216+36 = 252.

PRACTICE

Find the next number: 1, 2, 6, 24, 120, ?

A. 600

B. 620

C. 720

D. 840

Answer: C. Multipliers are 2, 3, 4, 5, next is 6. 120 × 6 = 720 (these are factorials).

PRACTICE

Which number is the odd one out? 8, 27, 64, 100, 125, 216

A. 27

B. 64

C. 100

D. 216

Answer: C. All others are perfect cubes (2^3, 3^3, 4^3, 5^3, 6^3). 100 is not a cube.

PRACTICE

Find the next number: 2, 5, 4, 10, 8, 20, 16, ?

A. 32

B. 36

C. 40

D. 44

Answer: C. Two series mixed: positions 1, 3, 5, 7 are 2, 4, 8, 16 (×2); positions 2, 4, 6 are 5, 10, 20 (×2). The next is 20 × 2 = 40.

RECALL BOX: CLOSE THE NOTES AND WRITE THESE IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Without looking: write the five rules for number series and one example for each.